Groundwork — Weekly Build Report

Monday 26 – Saturday 31 October 2026

Prepared for Ruth Ijoma

This is a plain-language record of what was built on the Groundwork platform this week, what is finished, and what is still outstanding. It is written for someone who is not working in the code, so each item says what it means for a contractor or a client rather than how it was implemented.

93 changes were committed across five working days. Wednesday was by far the largest single day, at 57. The week's two themes were the project-creation wizard (reading a bill of quantities and a floor plan so a contractor does not retype their own estimate) and a full redesign of the contractor surface.

One thing to know before reading further

None of this week's work is live on tryjalla.com yet. Everything described here runs on the development machine. Philip saw older screens several times during Friday's session for this reason, not because of browser caching.

Three things have to happen before anyone outside the team can see it: the work is deployed, five database migrations are applied, and one email key is set. These are listed in **What is blocked** on the last pages.

Day by day

Monday 26 October

No changes recorded

Nothing was committed to the codebase on Monday. The week's work begins Tuesday.

Tuesday 27 October

10 changes

Onboarding and the partner application.

- **Phone numbers now validate properly everywhere.** The old check only accepted one strict international format and rejected numbers people actually type. It was replaced across sign-up, onboarding and every form that takes a number. This matters for WhatsApp: a number that fails to save is a client or contractor we cannot reach.
- **A confirmation email is now sent when a contractor finishes onboarding.** Previously they completed the form and heard nothing back.
- **The partner application became one question per screen.** It was a single long form; it now moves question by question, which is what makes it possible to see where people stop.
- **An 'almost there' step was added at the end of contractor onboarding**, and the contractor agreement and privacy wording were updated.
- **Contractors can now create a project without first onboarding a client.** Before this, a contractor with their own build had no way in.

Wednesday 28 October

57 changes — the largest day of the week

The project-creation wizard, and reading documents instead of asking questions.

- **A contractor can upload a floor plan and a bill of quantities, and Groundwork reads them.** It takes the total from the bill, the number of floors, the footprint area and the currency, rather than making someone retype figures they already have in a document. This is the single biggest change of the week.

- **Multiple floor plans are supported**, with proper file validation, so a building drawn across several sheets can be uploaded as it exists.
- **'Your project at a glance'** was added — a summary screen that comes back pre-filled from the documents, so the contractor confirms rather than enters.
- **Target start and end dates were added to the wizard.** (On Saturday the start date became mandatory — see below.)
- **Country selection was reworked** so the countries we actually serve come first and search works properly.
- **A large amount of dead weight was removed:** the old payment modal, the Jalla Verify checkout, the subscription tab, unused plan logic and several payment routes that no longer led anywhere. Fewer places for a user to get lost.
- **Sign-up now gives real feedback** when registration succeeds or fails, instead of leaving people guessing.

Thursday 29 October

14 changes

The contractor surface redesign, and money shown in the right currency.

- **The whole contractor surface was redesigned** — Dashboard, Projects, and the five tabs inside a project: Work, Money, Documents, Messages and People. The People tab is new: it shows who is on a project and is where a contractor invites their client.
- **Money is now shown in the project's own currency with the dollar beside it**, using a live exchange rate fetched once per session rather than a stale stored number.
- **Contractors can own their own projects.** Previously a contractor who built their own project was treated as a client afterwards and dropped into the wrong part of the app.
- **The stage pipeline reflects the stage actually selected**, so the ten-dot progress line on each project is accurate.

Friday 30 October

11 changes, plus a three-hour working session with Philip

Mobile, the live review, and a long list of corrections.

- **A bottom tab bar was added for mobile** — Dashboard, Projects, Payouts, Profile — across all ten contractor screens. The approved designs all showed one; the app had a hamburger menu instead. This was the largest single gap between the designs and the build.
- **The navigation bug Philip reported was found and fixed.** Pressing 'New project' or the logo inside it sent a contractor into the client view. The cause was that the project wizard had its logo hard-coded to the client dashboard while its Cancel button was role-aware — two controls leaving the same screen disagreeing about where 'out' was.
- **Help was rebuilt for contractors.** The Help button led to a page that lives inside the client layout, so a contractor pressing it was dropped into the client's sidebar. There is now a separate contractor help page with contractor questions, fully translated into French.
- **The client invitation email was written.** This turned out never to have existed: the system recorded the invitation and showed 'Invitation sent to...', but no email was ever sent. Every person invited since that feature shipped was told mail had gone out when none had.
- **Money figures were corrected.** 'Contract value' and 'Still to come' now come from the project schedule, and a stage that was finished before the project joined Groundwork no longer distorts the totals.
- **A long list of wording changes** from Philip's recorded review was applied across the dashboard, Work, Money, Documents, People and Profile, in English and French.

Saturday 31 October

Early-hours continuation of Friday's session

Measurement: making the numbers the team reports trustworthy.

- **A shared definition of a qualified and a verified project** was written into the database, so every report counts the same thing. Qualified means a bill of quantities *and* a start date within 60 days. Verified means the client actually accepted their invitation *and* there is at least one site update. Everything else is general. Before this there was no shared definition anywhere, which is why the numbers in Thursday's review disagreed with each other.
- **Sign-up, contractor onboarding and partner application became three separate tracked sequences**, each with a real beginning and end. They were previously one chain, which hid a double count: finishing onboarding with 'I have a project' was also being read as the start of a partner application, so one click was counted as the end of one thing and the start of another.
- **The negative numbers on the contractor records page were removed.** The cards showed drops between stages as -50, -14, -10. They now show eight positive counts — onboarding complete, onboarding not finished, application filed, no application yet, and so on — and each card is clickable and filters the list below it. A gap between two numbers tells you nothing; a set of people you can press and then ring does.
- **A real bug in the payment figures was found and fixed.** Philip asked where the recorded payments were coming from, since nobody had been paid. The answer was that the page counted every row in the payment ledger, including money coming *in* from clients and payments that had failed or were only authorised. It now counts only money that actually reached a contractor.
- **The project start date is now mandatory**, because it is half of what makes a project qualified, and a field nobody fills in is a number nobody can report.
- **A note alone can no longer be submitted as site work.** A photo or file is now required, as Philip asked — otherwise an item could be ticked off with nothing to look at.

Where things stand

Finished and checked in a browser

Each of these was driven in a real browser on both desktop and phone widths before being called done.

- Contractor dashboard, Projects list, and all five project tabs.
- Mobile bottom tab bar on all ten contractor screens.
- Navigation fixes: the logo, Cancel and Help all keep a contractor in their own view.
- Contractor help page, in English and French.
- Photo and file upload, including the camera on a phone.
- All of Philip's wording changes from the Friday recording.
- Contractor records cards rebuilt as positive, clickable filters.

Checked by automated tests only, not yet seen in a browser

- **The mandatory project start date.** The logic is covered by tests; the screen itself has not been clicked through.
- **The contractor records cards.** The test account available is a contractor, not an administrator, so that page could not be opened. It needs an admin login before the numbers on it are relied on.

Blocked — these need an action, not more development

Five migrations are written and tested but not applied

166 lets an invited client reply in the project chat. Until it runs, a client can watch a project but cannot speak in it.

167, 168 were already outstanding from last week.

169 is the qualified / verified project definition.

170 is the three-sequence funnel tracking.

Each has been validated against a real PostgreSQL database. They need running in Supabase.

- **Nothing is deployed.** All of this week's work is on the development machine.
- **RESEND_API_KEY must be set in Vercel**, or the new client invitation email still will not send.

Not started

- **The Documents section rebuild.** Philip identified this as a real rework rather than a wording change: filtering, searching and organising documents, and files that currently cannot be opened.
- **Admin cards for projects** — totals for all, qualified, verified and incomplete projects, with filters. The definitions behind them now exist; the cards do not.
- **The contractor walkthrough** — four guided flows covering completing a profile, applying to be a partner, inviting a client, and managing a project. Requested in both the team memo and the Chia walkthrough session.
- **The client walkthrough** — same request, for the client side.
- **Contractor onboarding clean-up** — the sign-up, login and email confirmation problems Kiitu Ghislain hit on Tuesday are still open.
- **Verification revenue mapping** — not begun. Worth noting that verification is currently hidden across the contractor surface, so this maps a journey to a feature that is switched off.
- **Removing test projects** from the live platform, so the numbers and the screens are readable.

Decisions waiting on Philip or Favour

These are blocking nothing today, but each one is a question only they can answer.

- Should the Money progress bar track approved stage value, or money actually paid? They are genuinely different numbers, which is why they disagree on screen.
- Should the contractor agreement signature have to match the name on the account? At present any two characters are accepted as a signature.
- Philip asked to remove the sentence telling French applicants that Vanessa joins their call. Her name was kept in the 'who you will speak to' list — should that come off too?
- Whether Vanessa is actually a co-host on the French booking calendar. The platform sends French applicants to the correct separate calendar, but who is on that calendar is set in Google and cannot be checked from the platform.

Health of the codebase

- 3,470 automated tests passing.
- 9 failures, all of which pre-date this week's work and are unchanged by it.
- No type errors.

Report covers commits from Monday 26 October to Saturday 31 October 2026. Counts are taken from the project's version history, not from memory.